



**Turning Strategy into Results -
the link between strategy,
projects, and people**

Prof. Mario H Trentim

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Turning Strategy into Results: the link between strategy, projects, and people

A journey through the art of materializing strategic visions through well-executed projects and engaged people.

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Agenda

1

The Execution Challenge

Why brilliant strategies often fail in implementation

2

The Execution Bridge

How to connect strategic vision and concrete results

3

The Three Pillars

Strategy, Projects, and People: the tripod of effective execution

4

The Execution Helix

An integrated model to transform strategy into results

5

Challenges and Solutions

Overcoming common obstacles in the execution journey

6

The Future of Execution

Trends and essential skills in a volatile world

The Strategy Paradox

Sophisticated strategies, elaborated over months, often fail in weeks. Technically perfect projects lose relevance when disconnected from the organizational vision. This is the paradox that haunts organizations around the world.

The problem is rarely in the strategic document or the project management methodology itself. The difference between success and failure lies in:

- Consistent execution discipline
- Ability to align people around clear objectives
- Accurate definition of roles and responsibilities
- Establishment of relevant metrics and systematic monitoring

Strategy cannot be only an annual event, but a living process that permeates all organizational decisions.

"Plans are only good intentions unless they immediately transform into hard work."

— Peter Drucker



Reality in Organizations

67%

Strategies Fail

More than two-thirds of well-formulated strategies do not achieve their objectives due to execution failures.

61%

Misalignment

Percentage of employees who cannot identify their organizations' strategic priorities.

83%

Strategic Projects

Organizations that report disconnection between their projects and the strategic objectives defined by the leadership.

These numbers reveal a challenging reality: the link between strategy, projects, and people is often broken in organizations, resulting in waste of resources, lost opportunities, and teams demotivation. The "execution bridge" is the absent element that prevents the potential value contained in the strategic plans from materializing.

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Strategy beyond Planning

"Strategy is not only a plan, but also a pattern and perspective. It needs to be alive in the day-to-day life of the organization—not as a document forgotten in a drawer, but as a compass that guides decisions, priorities, and investments."

Henry Mintzberg, one of strategy's greatest thinkers, reminds us that true strategy transcends the formal document. It manifests itself in everyday decisions, established priorities, and resource allocation. When strategy becomes part of the organizational DNA, execution flows naturally, as each choice and action is intrinsically aligned with the greater purpose.

An effective strategy requires:

- Clarity of purpose and direction
- Focus on deliberate choices
- Adaptability to change
- Constant and transparent communication
- Translation into concrete goals and indicators
- Deployment across all organizational levels
- Alignment with culture and values
- Learning and adjustment mechanisms

First Fundamental Principle: Strategy is Choice

"The essence of strategy is to choose what not to do."

— Michael Porter

Organizations that try to embrace all opportunities end up dispersing resources and losing focus. The real strategy lies not only in what you decide to do, but mainly in what you decide **not to do**.

Defining clear priorities is the first step to ensure that truly relevant projects receive the attention and appropriate resources for their effective execution.

The discipline of strategic choices manifests itself in:

- Resource concentration in areas of differentiation
- Conscious abandonment of opportunities that dilute focus
- Clarity about what constitutes success for the organization
- Transparent communication about what will not be prioritized

Second Fundamental Principle: Projects are Strategy Vehicles

The PMI (Project Management Institute) defines project as "a temporary effort undertaken to create a unique product, service, or result". In practice, it is the projects that materialize the strategy. They are the ones that transform intentions into tangible reality.

Concrete Translation

Projects translate abstract strategic concepts into specific and measurable deliveries, allowing the organization to move toward its vision in tangible steps.

Focused Allocation

By structuring initiatives as projects, the organization is able to direct financial, human, and technological resources in an optimized way, maximizing the return on the strategic investment.

Accountability

Projects establish clear responsibilities, defined deadlines, and success metrics, creating an environment conducive to accountability and results measurement.

Projects as Strategy Manifestations



Digital Transformation

Projects that implement new technologies, redesign processes, and develop digital skills to materialize innovation and competitiveness strategies.



International Expansion

Structured initiatives to conquer new markets, establish global operations, and adapt products and services to different cultural contexts.



Products Development

Projects that transform market insights into innovative offers, materializing growth and competitive differentiation strategies.



Organizational Change

Initiatives that reconfigure structures, processes, and culture to align the organization with the new strategic directions and demands of the environment.

Each type of project requires specific management approaches, but all share the fundamental purpose of materializing aspects of the organizational strategy, creating tangible value for stakeholders.

Third Fundamental Principle: People are the Execution Energy

Even the best strategic plan and most robust project management method depend fundamentally on the human factor. They are the people who:

- Interpret the strategy and translate it into concrete actions
- Overcome unforeseen obstacles with creativity and persistence
- Collaborate to create solutions that transcend individual capabilities
- Maintain commitment to results even in challenging moments

Three elements are determinant to enhance people's contribution in strategic execution:

1. **Inspiring leadership** that connects efforts to greater purposes
2. **Organizational culture** that values execution and results
3. **Continuous development** of technical and behavioral skills

| "People do not move only by processes; they move by meaning."

Genuine engagement happens when each person understands not only the **how** of their work, but mainly the **why** – its connection with the organization's greater purpose and the impact it generates for customers, society, and other stakeholders.

The Importance of Governance

Governance is the mechanism that maintains strategy, projects, and people aligned. It establishes clear rules, decision-making processes, and monitoring mechanisms that ensure consistency and focus on strategic execution.

- Strategic PMO
A Project Management Office (PMO) that acts beyond the technical perspective, functioning as a guardian of the alignment between the project portfolio and the organization's strategic objectives.
- Portfolio Management
Systematic process to select, prioritize, and monitor the organization's set of projects, ensuring that resources are allocated to the initiatives of greatest strategic value.
- Balanced Scorecard
Methodology developed by Kaplan and Norton that translates the strategy into tangible indicators distributed into four perspectives: financial, customers, internal processes, and learning/growth.
- Management Rituals
Structured meetings for results monitoring, decision-making, and replanning, which maintain focus on execution and allow quick adjustments when necessary.

The Power of the Strategic Narrative

A solid governance structure is essential, but insufficient. It is necessary to go beyond and create a strategic narrative that engages people emotionally and intellectually.

"Successful transformation is 70% leadership and 30% management."

— John Kotter

The effective strategic narrative:

- Connects the strategy to the organization's greater purpose
- Explains the "why" behind the strategic choices
- Translates abstract concepts into concrete and relevant terms
- Personalizes the message for different audiences and contexts
- Uses stories, metaphors, and examples that resonate emotionally
- Recognizes challenges and celebrates advances throughout the journey

Effective leaders are skilled storytellers who transform strategy into a compelling narrative about the future the organization is building. When well executed, this narrative mobilizes hearts and minds, generating the necessary impulse to overcome obstacles and persevere toward the strategic objectives.

Technology as an Execution Ally



Collaborative Platforms

Tools that integrate distributed teams, facilitate information sharing, and allow synchronized work regardless of geographical or departmental barriers.



Artificial Intelligence

Advanced algorithms that analyze project data, identify risks, optimize resource allocation, and suggest adjustments to maximize the strategic portfolio's chances of success.



Real-Time Dashboards

Visual dashboards that consolidate strategic and operational KPIs, offering instant visibility into the progress of initiatives and allowing agile interventions when necessary.



Mobile Applications

Solutions that take strategic management to mobile devices, democratizing access to information and facilitating decision-making even outside the traditional corporate environment.

Technology amplifies what already exists in the organization: if there is clarity and discipline, it accelerates results; if there is confusion and misalignment, it only makes failure more visible and faster. Success in technological adoption depends on aligning tools with the real needs of strategic execution.

The Change Resistance Challenge

One of the most common obstacles to effective strategic execution is resistance to change. Strategic projects often fail not because of technical issues, but because they confront established routines, threaten comfort zones, or require skills that have not yet been developed.

Resistances manifest in several ways:

Explicit Resistances

- Direct questioning about the need for change
- Argumentation about risks and potential problems
- Constant request for more information and guarantees
- Limited participation or conditioned to requirements

Implicit Resistances

- Verbal agreement without corresponding actions
- Exaggerated focus on details to postpone important decisions
- Constant references to previous failures
- Lack of prioritization of change-related activities

Overcoming these resistances requires a structured change management process, which combines transparent communication, active participation, and continuous support.

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Change Management: Critical Element for Execution

Awareness

Build clear understanding about the need for change, connecting it to real challenges and relevant opportunities for the organization and its members.

Desire

Generate intrinsic motivation to participate and support change, answering the fundamental question "What is in this for me and us?"

Knowledge

Develop understanding about how to change, providing information, training, and resources necessary to adopt new behaviors and practices.

Habilidade (Skill)

Transforming knowledge into practical skills through opportunities for application and constructive feedback and continuous improvement.

Reinforcement

Consolidate change with recognition, results celebration, and adjustments in organizational systems to make the new state sustainable.

This model, inspired by Jeffrey Hiatt's ADKAR methodology, offers a roadmap to lead people through the change journey necessary for successful strategic execution.

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The Execution Helix: An Integrated Model

The Execution Helix is a conceptual model that integrates the three fundamental elements to transform strategy into results. As an organizational DNA structure, it represents the genetic coding that determines the execution ability.

Strategy

Provides clear direction and defines the priorities. Establishes the "where to" and "why" of the organizational journey, creating the context for decisions and actions at all levels.

Governance

Ensures alignment, monitoring, and route correction. Establishes the game rules, decision mechanisms, and processes that maintain the organization on the right path.

Execution

Transforms plans into concrete actions through projects and initiatives. It is the engine that converts potential into reality through coordinated efforts and consistent discipline.

When these three helixes rotate in synchrony, the organization advances in a sustainable way. When one of them stops or slows down, the entire system loses strength and momentum.

Strategy: The First Helix

Essential Elements

- **Inspiring purpose** that transcends financial results
- **Clear vision** of the desired future for the organization
- **Distinctive positioning** that creates unique value
- Specific and measurable **strategic objectives**
- **Explicit choices** about what to do and what not to do
- **Business model** that enables value creation

Recommended Practices

- Periodic review of the competitive environment and trends
- Broad involvement in strategic formulation
- Consistent communication and adapted to different audiences
- Deployment into goals for all organizational levels

"A strategy only becomes real when it is expressed in terms of specific actions that people understand and to which they can commit to."

The quality of the strategy determines the maximum potential of execution. A strategy that is unclear, overly complex, or disconnected from organizational reality compromises the entire system, regardless of the excellence of governance mechanisms or execution discipline.

Governance: The Second Helix



Direction

Establishes clear priorities and decision criteria that guide resource allocation and efforts at all organizational levels, ensuring consistency with the strategy.



Alignment

Creates mechanisms to ensure that initiatives in different areas and levels are synchronized, maximizing synergies and minimizing priority conflicts.



Monitoring

Establishes processes for monitoring results and key indicators, providing visibility into progress, and identifying deviations in a timely manner.



Adaptation

Promotes continuous learning and creates mechanisms to adjust directions and actions based on results achieved and changes in the environment.

Effective governance finds the delicate balance between control and flexibility. Too rigid, it stifles innovation and adaptability; too loose, it allows for dispersion and inconsistency. The secret is in creating structures that ensure focus without compromising the ability to respond to change.

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The Critical Role of Leadership

Leadership is the catalyst element that energizes the entire Execution Helix system. Effective leaders play multiple roles throughout the journey of transformation from strategy into results:

Architects of Strategy

They set inspiring directions and make brave choices that shape the future of the organization, considering both aspirations and real limitations.

Capability Builders

They develop systems, processes, and especially people capable of materializing the strategic vision through consistent and coordinated actions.

Obstacle Removers

They identify and eliminate barriers that prevent the flow of execution, whether they are structural, procedural, technological, or behavioral.

Guardians of Alignment

They ensure consistency between words and actions, making decisions that reinforce strategic priorities and demonstrating exemplary behavior.

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Leadership in Different Levels



Although the roles are different in each level, all leaders share the fundamental responsibility to create connections between strategy and action, between the "why" and "how", between organizational aspirations and everyday realities.

Successful strategic execution requires alignment and consistency between these different levels of leadership. When there are contradictions or disconnections, confusion, cynicism, and loss of momentum arise that compromise results.

High-performance organizations deliberately invest in the development of leadership capabilities at all levels, recognizing that the strength of the execution chain depends on each of its links.

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Communication: The Nervous System of Execution

Effective communication is to strategic execution what the nervous system is to the human body: the mechanism that transmits information, coordinates actions, and ensures appropriate responses to internal and external stimuli.

Principles of Strategic Communication

- **Clarity above all else:** Simple and direct messages that do not leave room for mistaken interpretations
- **Consistency in messages:** Alignment between different channels and issuers, avoiding contradictions that generate confusion
- **Personalized contextualization:** Adaptation of the message to different audiences, considering their perspectives and specific interests
- **Two-way communication:** Effective mechanisms for listening, not just talking, creating genuine dialogue
- **Intentional redundancy:** Conscious repetition of key messages by different means to ensure absorption

Communication in Critical Moments

Some moments require special attention to communication during the strategic execution journey:

- **Launch of the strategy:** Create shared understanding and initial enthusiasm
- **Important milestones:** Celebrate achievements and reinforce the sense of progress
- **Obstacles and setbacks:** Maintain transparency and focus on overcoming challenges
- **Route adjustments:** Explain changes and ensure understanding of new directions
- **Leadership transitions:** Ensuring continuity and commitment in times of change

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Practical Tools for Strategic Communication



Strategic Map

Visual representation of the strategy that shows cause-and-effect relationships between objectives, facilitating understanding of how different elements connect to generate results.



Strategic Narratives

Structured stories that contextualize the strategy, connecting the organization's past, present and future in a coherent and memorable narrative.

The choice of tools must take into account the organizational culture, the nature of the strategy, and the characteristics of the target audience. The best tool is the one that effectively connects people to strategy and inspires aligned action.



OKRs

Objectives and Key Results: a methodology that connects inspiring objectives with measurable key results, creating transparency and alignment around shared goals.



Visual Communication

Videos, infographics and other visual resources that translate complex concepts into an accessible and engaging format for different internal and external audiences.

Metrics: What Gets Measured Gets Managed

"What is measured improves. What is measured and reported improves exponentially."

— Karl Pearson

Effective metrics are key to translating strategy into concrete results. They function as guiding lights that keep the organization on the right track, offering:

- Clarity about what constitutes success
- Objective mechanisms to monitor progress
- Factual basis for decision-making
- Common language for organizational alignment
- Motivation and accountability tool

Metrics Hierarchy

An effective system of metrics establishes clear connections between different levels of indicators:

1. **Final Results Indicators:** Measure the last success of the strategy (e.g., market share, customer satisfaction)
2. **Intermediate Results Indicators:** Signal progress toward the final results (e.g., customer acquisition, improvements in processes)
3. **Effort Indicators:** Measure activities and initiatives that drive results (e.g., number of customer visits, implementation of new systems)

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Characteristics of Effective Metrics



Balanced

They cover multiple dimensions of organizational performance, avoiding an exclusive focus on financial or short-term aspects to the detriment of indicators of sustainability and organizational health.



Connected

They establish clear cause-and-effect relationships between different levels, allowing each person to understand how their actions impact the organization's greater results.



Actionable

They provide information that can effectively generate corrective or reinforcement actions, with an appropriate degree of specificity and timeliness to guide decisions.



Shared

They promote collaboration and alignment between different areas, avoiding local optimizations that harm global results or destructive competition between departments.

An excess of metrics can be as harmful as their absence. High-performance organizations focus on a limited set of truly strategic indicators (5–7 per level), avoiding analytical paralysis and dispersion of attention.

Organizational Culture: The Soil of Execution

Organizational culture is the ground where the seed of strategy is planted. Even the best strategy, supported by the most sophisticated governance mechanisms, will not flourish in infertile or hostile soil.

"Culture eats strategy at breakfast."
— Peter Drucker

This famous phrase by Drucker reminds us that culture – the set of shared beliefs, values, and behaviors – has immense power to facilitate or prevent strategic execution.

Culture manifests in tangible and intangible elements:

Visible Elements

- Observable behaviors
- Rituals and celebrations
- Physical environment
- Language and jargon used
- Celebrated stories

Invisible Elements

- Basic assumptions
- Fundamental values
- Shared beliefs
- Unwritten standards
- Dominant mental models

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Execution-Oriented Culture

Focus on Results

Valuation of concrete deliveries above activities or efforts. Clarity about what constitutes success and collective commitment to its achievement.

Accountability

Assumption of personal responsibility for results.
Genuine commitment to promises made and
transparency about advances and obstacles.

Agility

Ability to quickly respond to change. Valuation of experimentation, continuous learning, and evidence-based adaptation.

Collaboration

Joint work for common objectives. Overcoming departmental silos and prioritizing collective success over individual gains.

Discipline

Consistency in the application of methods and practices.
Meticulous attention to details and commitment to high quality standards.

Courage

Willingness to face difficult challenges. Openness to confront uncomfortable realities and make necessary decisions even when unpopular.

Culture does not change by decree or speech, but by consistent actions of leadership, aligned recognition systems, and stories that celebrate desired behaviors.

Transforming Culture

Changing culture is one of the most complex challenges in management. It is a gradual process that requires interventions at multiple levels and consistency over time. Some effective approaches include:

Systemic Approach

- **Leadership by example:** Consistent behaviors of high leadership that model the desired values
- **Symbols and rituals:** Creation of moments that visually and emotionally reinforce the desired cultural elements
- **Stories and narratives:** Dissemination of concrete examples that illustrate culture in action
- **Management systems:** Alignment of recruitment, evaluation, and recognition processes with the desired values
- **Leadership development:** Preparation of managers at all levels to be ambassadors of culture

Principles for Cultural Change

1. **Focus on a few critical elements** that really impact execution
2. **Clear connection with results** to demonstrate practical relevance
3. **Broad involvement** to create a sense of collective ownership
4. **Celebration of initial wins** to create momentum
5. **Patience and persistence** recognizing that cultural changes are gradual
6. **Progress measurement** with specific indicators of cultural change

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Skills Development: The Human Engine of Execution

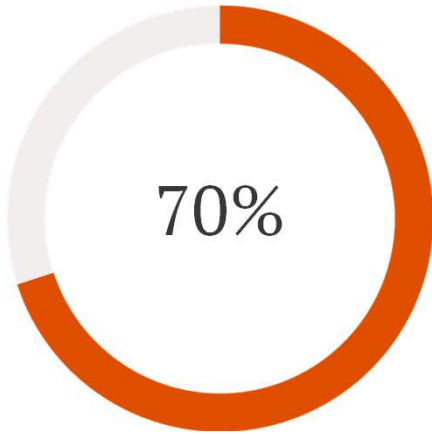
Turning strategy into results requires people with specific skills. While culture creates the conducive environment, they are the individual and collective capabilities that determine the maximum execution potential.

A comprehensive model of skills for strategic execution includes:

- **Technical Skills**
Specific knowledge and skills necessary to execute activities with excellence, such as project management, data analysis, financial planning, or functional expertise.
- **Behavioral Skills**
Attitudes and behaviors that enhance execution, such as focus on results, resilience, collaboration, critical thinking, and the ability to adapt.
- **Contextual Skills**
Deep understanding of the organizational environment, including strategic vision, business knowledge, understanding of the market, and perception of internal dynamics.

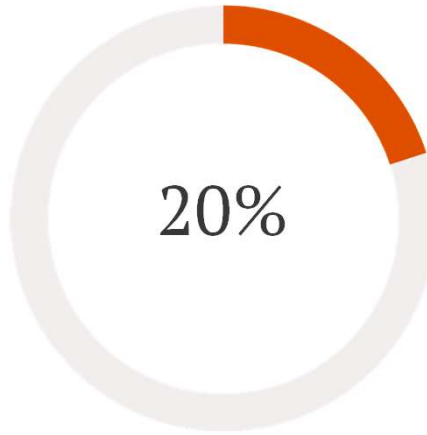
The development of these skills must be a continuous and intentional process, not an isolated event or specific initiative.

70:20:10 Development Model



Practical Experiences

Learning through real challenges at work, such as participation in strategic projects, new responsibilities, or situations that require overcoming obstacles.



Social Interactions

Learning through relationships, such as mentoring, peer feedback, communities of practice, and observation of role models.



Formal Education

Structured learning through courses, training, workshops, and educational materials that provide conceptual fundamentals and best practices.

This model, developed by the Center for Creative Leadership, recognizes that the development of strategic execution skills occurs primarily in the flow of actual work, complemented by meaningful interactions and solid conceptual foundations.

High-performance organizations deliberately create opportunities for the three types of learning, with special emphasis on challenging experiences and appropriate support.

Accelerated Skills Development



This systematic process allows organizations to quickly develop the necessary capabilities to execute their strategies, creating a virtuous circle where more competent people generate better results, which in turn create new development opportunities.

Common Challenges in Strategic Execution



Lack of Clarity

Ambiguous or excessively complex strategy that does not clearly translate priorities and directions, generating confusion and dispersion of efforts in multiple disconnected initiatives.



Organizational Silos

Structures and mindsets, which encourage local optimization to the detriment of global results, creating barriers to collaboration necessary for execution of transversal initiatives.



Competing Priorities

Proliferation of initiatives classified as "priority" without effective choice and focus mechanisms, leading to dilution of resources and attention on multiple fronts.

Identifying these challenges is the first step to overcome them. High-performance organizations proactively address these obstacles as an integral part of the strategic execution process.

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More Common Challenges in Strategic Execution



Communication Failures

Inconsistent or excessively abstract messages that cannot translate the strategy into meaningful terms for different audiences, generating misalignment and conflicting interpretations.

Each challenge requires specific approaches, but all share the need for awareness, accurate diagnosis, and systemic intervention that addresses fundamental causes, not only superficial symptoms.



Skill Gaps

Absence of technical, behavioral, or contextual skills necessary to execute the strategy, creating bottlenecks and compromising quality and implementation speed.



Focus on the Short-Term

Pressure for immediate results that sacrifices long-term strategic investments, creating a vicious cycle of reactive management and inability to build sustainable competitive advantages.

Overcoming Strategies: Clarity and Communication

Challenge: Lack of Strategic Clarity

The strategy is ambiguous, too complex, or does not clearly translate priorities, generating confusion and dispersion of efforts.

Solutions:

1. **Clarity test:** Check whether leaders at different levels can consistently articulate the strategic priorities
2. **Radical simplification:** Reduce the strategy to a few essential elements (3–5 priorities) that can be easily communicated and remembered
3. **Visualization:** Create graphical representations of strategy that make relationships and priorities immediately visible
4. **Contextualized translation:** Help each area to understand what the strategy means specifically for its context and responsibilities

Challenge: Communication Failures

Inconsistent or abstract messages cannot translate the strategy into meaningful terms, generating misalignment.

Solutions:

1. **Strategic narrative:** Develop a coherent story that connects past, present, and future, giving meaning and context to the strategy
2. **Multiple channels:** Use different formats and platforms to reach different audiences, considering preferences and learning styles.
3. **Two-way communication:** Create forums for questions, clarifications, and feedback that allow you to adjust and improve messages
4. **Communication kit:** Provide tools and materials that help leaders at all levels to communicate consistently

Strategies for Overcoming Challenges: Capabilities and Long-Term Vision

Challenge: Skills Gaps

Absence of necessary skills to execute the strategy, creating bottlenecks and compromising implementation.

Solutions:

1. **Systematic evaluation:** Accurately identify necessary critical skills and map current gaps
2. **Integrated planning:** Align people strategy with business strategy, predicting future needs
3. **Multiple approach:** Combine internal development, strategic hiring, and external partnerships to fill gaps
4. **Communities of practice:** Create groups for knowledge sharing and accelerated development in critical areas

Challenge: Focus on the Short-Term

Pressure for immediate results that sacrifices long-term strategic investments, creating a vicious cycle.

Solutions:

1. **Dual horizon:** Establish and monitor explicitly short and long-term objectives, recognizing tensions and interdependencies
2. **Resource protection:** Allocate dedicated resources to strategic initiatives that cannot be redirected to operational needs
3. **Balanced incentives:** Tie a significant part of variable remuneration to medium and long-term results
4. **Journey narrative:** Consistently communicate the strategy as a continuous process, not a one-time event, with clear milestones along the way

The Future of Strategic Execution

Strategic execution will face growing challenges in the coming years, driven by deep changes in the business environment and society. Some trends that will shape the future of execution:



Exponential Acceleration

Increasingly shorter cycles of technological and market change will require the ability to strategic adapt in real time, challenging traditional planning and execution models.



Systemic Complexity

Growing interconnections between markets, technologies, and stakeholders will create increasingly complex decision environments, requiring new approaches for prioritization and coordination.



Distributed Work

Hybrid and remote work models will demand new ways to create alignment, maintain engagement, and coordinate execution without dependence on constant in-person interactions.



Increased Intelligence

Growing integration between human and artificial intelligence will create new possibilities for planning, monitoring, and strategic adaptation in real time.

Agile Strategy Execution

The future of strategic execution will increasingly incorporate the principles of agility, not only in software development, but as an organizational philosophy that permeates all aspects of strategic implementation.



Continuous Iteration

Replacement of long planning–execution cycles with short loops of experimentation, learning, and adjustment, allowing quick adaptation to new information and circumstances.



Focus on Value

Strict prioritization of initiatives based on value generated for stakeholders, with mechanisms to quickly abandon initiatives that do not demonstrate expected results.



Autonomous Teams

Empowerment of multifunctional teams with the ability to make local decisions within clear strategic guidelines, accelerating execution and promoting innovation.



Intensive Feedback

Creation of mechanisms for collection and constant incorporation of insights from customers, employees, and partners, continuously calibrating direction and approach.

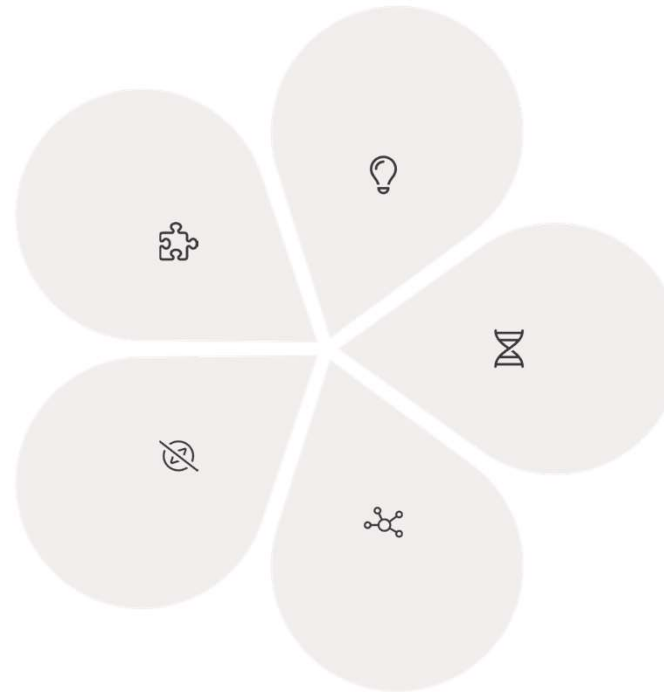
Future Skills for Strategic Execution

Systemic Thinking

Ability to understand complex interconnections, identify emerging patterns, and anticipate nonlinear consequences of actions and decisions in adaptive systems.

Adaptive Agility

Ability to navigate ambiguity, quickly adjust directions and approaches, and maintain effectiveness even in contexts of high volatility and uncertainty.



Strategic Creativity

Ability to imagine alternative futures, question embedded assumptions, and develop innovative approaches to apparently intractable challenges.

Digital Fluency

Deep understanding of emerging technologies and ability to identify relevant strategic applications, evaluating risks and opportunities with discernment.

Exponential Collaboration

Ability to form and activate broad collaborative networks, mobilizing resources beyond organizational borders to create shared value.

These skills do not replace traditional management skills, but complement and enhance them, allowing effective application of perennial execution principles in radically new contexts.

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Preparing the Organization for the Future of Execution

Skills Assessment

Comprehensive evaluation of current strengths and gaps in relation to the three pillars of the Execution Helix: strategy, governance, and execution, identifying development opportunities.

Leadership Development

Deliberate investment in the skills that will allow leaders to navigate growing complexity, including systemic thinking, adaptive intelligence, and influence in networks.

Structured Experimentation

Creation of safe spaces to test new execution approaches on a controlled scale, with robust mechanisms to capture learning and scale successes.

Processes Reformulation

Redesign of decision-making processes, resource allocation, and performance management to incorporate speed, flexibility, and orientation by purpose without sacrificing rigor.

Cultural Transformation

Intentional cultivation of values and behaviors that support adaptive execution, such as disciplined experimentation, continuous learning, and collaboration beyond borders.

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Conclusion: Turning Vision into Reality

"Strategy without execution is only illusion; execution without strategy is waste; execution without people is impossible."

Throughout this presentation, we explored how to transform strategy into concrete results through the powerful intersection of clear strategy, effective governance, and disciplined execution—what we call the Execution Helix.

We saw that successful strategic execution:

- Begins with **deliberate choices** about where to compete and how to win
- Depends on **robust mechanisms** to align, monitor, and adapt
- Requires **well-structured projects** as vehicles to materialize the strategy
- Is driven by the **human energy** of engaged and competent people
- Thrives in **cultures** that value discipline, focus, and adaptability
- Is enhanced by **leadership** that connects purpose, direction, and action

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Beyond Implementation: Building Lasting Skills

True success in strategic execution is not only in implementing a specific plan, but in developing lasting organizational capabilities that allow consistent execution over time and in different contexts.

Strategic execution is not an event, but an organizational skill that must be cultivated consistently. Organizations that master this art not only execute well today, but build the foundations for superior execution tomorrow.

Lasting Skills

- **Strategic clarity:** Ability to define convincing directions and make difficult choices
- **Organizational alignment:** Ability to mobilize resources and energy around shared priorities
- **Execution discipline:** Consistency in the transformation of intentions into actions and concrete results
- **Strategic learning:** Ability to extract insights from successes and failures to refine approaches
- **Adaptability:** Ability to adjust directions and tactics in the face of changes in the environment

Final Inspiration: The Metaphor of the Bridge

To conclude, I offer a metaphor that has accompanied me throughout my journey as an executive, advisor, and professor: building bridges.

Strategic execution is essentially the art of building bridges between the present and the desired future. Like every great bridge:

Requires Clear Vision

The architect needs to clearly visualize the complete bridge before the first stone is laid, just like leaders need to have a clear vision of the future they want to create.

Demands Solid Foundations

Invisible structures below the surface are as important as visible arcs, as well as culture and skills are as crucial as strategies and plans.

Move Forward Step by Step

Each section of the bridge is methodically built on the previous one, just as strategic execution progresses through concrete and measurable milestones.

Unites Distant Margins

The ultimate purpose is to connect separate realities, just as strategic execution connects the present with apparently distant future possibilities.

Invitation to Action



Diagnose

Honestly evaluate your organization's current capabilities in the three elements of the Execution Helix. Where are the main strengths and gaps? What recurring patterns prevent results from materializing?



Prioritize

Identify a critical element to strengthen in each dimension: strategy, governance, and execution. Remember that interventions focused on a few critical elements generate more impact than dispersed initiatives.



Develop

Deliberately invest in the development of organizational and individual skills that will allow superior execution, with special focus on leadership training at all levels.



Practice

Apply the principles discussed in a specific strategic initiative, using it as a laboratory to consolidate practices and create success cases that can inspire the entire organization.

The transformation of strategy into results does not happen overnight. It is a journey that requires persistent commitment and continuous improvement. But each step in this direction generates tangible results and builds foundations for even greater achievements.

| "Projects are more than tasks with deadlines; they are bridges to the future that you want to build."

Thank you for participating in this learning journey. May your organization build extraordinary bridges between brilliant strategies and transformative results!

MBX

5 a 7 de setembro
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